ECONOMY • RAS PRELIMS NOTES

Economy of Rajasthan

State budget and finances, agriculture, industry, services, infrastructure, rural development and welfare schemes

Inside these notes

- Largest-producer and firsts grids for facts RAS loves to match
- Scheme table - name, purpose and who it serves
- Memory hooks and exam traps in every chapter

Dinesh Jangir
Founder, StuDy
Notes made for RAS aspirants - simple language, connected concepts, PYQ-based facts.

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How to use: read a chapter fully once, then revise only the tables, MEMORY HOOKS and EXAM TRAPS. Every fact here is written the way RAS papers ask it.

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Economy of Rajasthan — Master Structure

Economy is the most fact-heavy part of the RAS Prelims paper. RPSC does not ask deep theory here; it asks **state facts** — which sector is biggest, which crop is first, which scheme does what, which park is largest. This book is built exactly for that pattern. Read it as one connected story: a big desert state with rich minerals and livestock, a farming sector that carries half its people, a growing services sector led by tourism, an energy sector turning sunlight into its biggest asset, and a government that spends heavily on welfare.

MEMORY HOOK: Whenever RAS asks an economy question, it is usually checking one of four things — **rank** (first/largest/top), **place** (which district), **scheme** (which scheme does what), or **pair** (match the following). Almost every chapter below ends with grids built for exactly these four patterns.

Chapter 1 — Macro Overview of Rajasthan's Economy

1.1 The state at a glance

- Rajasthan is **India's largest state by area** (about 3.42 lakh sq km, roughly 10.4% of India's land area).
- Its population is about **5.5% of India's population** (Census 2011), though it holds a much larger share of the land — so population density is low compared to most big states.
- The state is divided for administration into districts and divisions; the capital is **Jaipur**.
- A large part of the west is the **Thar Desert** — the defining fact of this economy. Low and uncertain rainfall shapes farming, water policy, energy choices (sun and wind are abundant where rain is not) and even settlement patterns.

MEMORY HOOK: Rajasthan's economy is a desert economy that learned to sell what the desert gives — **sun, stone, sand-crops and livestock** — instead of fighting what it lacks (water).

1.2 The three sectors and their story

Every economy is divided into three sectors:

Sector	What it covers	Role in Rajasthan
Primary	Agriculture, livestock, forestry, fishing, mining	Employs the largest share of workers — about half the workforce depends on agriculture and allied work
Secondary	Manufacturing, construction, electricity, water supply	The smallest of the three in income share — industrialisation is still limited
Tertiary	Trade, hotels, transport, tourism, banking, IT, public services	The **fastest-growing** sector and the largest contributor to state income

- The classic Rajasthan pattern: **services lead in income, agriculture leads in jobs.** This gap — many workers producing a smaller share of income — is the state's central economic problem and appears in RAS papers again and again.

- Within agriculture, **livestock** is unusually important. In a dry state, animals survive drought years better than crops, so animal husbandry acts as insurance for the rural household.

EXAM TRAP: "Largest sector by employment" (agriculture) is NOT the same as "largest sector by income" (services). RAS loves swapping these two in statements.

1.3 GSDP, NSDP and per-capita income — the concepts

- **GSDP (Gross State Domestic Product)** = the total value of all goods and services produced within Rajasthan in a year. It is the state-level twin of India's GDP.
- **NSDP (Net State Domestic Product)** = GSDP minus depreciation (the wear and tear of machines, buildings and roads used up in production).
- **Per-capita income** = state income divided by population. It is the average prosperity measure; Rajasthan's per-capita income stays **below the national average**, one of the standard "issues" facts.
- Figures are published at **current prices** (in today's money) and **constant prices** (adjusted to one base year's prices, to show real growth). Growth-rate questions always refer to constant prices.

PYQ PATTERN: RAS frequently asks a matching question on these terms — GSDP, NSDP, per-capita income — against their definitions. Learn the three definitions above word-for-word.

- Exact GSDP values change every year and are revised often; RAS tests the **concepts, sector shares story and rank facts**, not one year's rupee figure. That is why this book teaches the structure, not memorised totals.

1.4 The state's strengths

Strength	Why it matters
Minerals	Rajasthan is among India's richest mineral states — lead-zinc, silver, rock phosphate, limestone, marble, granite; often called a **museum of minerals**
Livestock	One of India's largest livestock populations; a top milk producer
Solar energy	Highest solar potential in India; huge solar parks (see Chapter 5)
Tourism	Forts, palaces, desert, fairs — tourism is a declared industry and a major services earner
Crops of national rank	India's largest producer of **bajra, mustard, guar** and a leading wool producer
Location	On the Delhi–Mumbai corridor; long border with Pakistan gives strategic trade importance

1.5 The structural challenges

- **Water scarcity** — the single biggest constraint. Low rainfall, over-drawn groundwater in many blocks, and dependence on a few river systems (Chambal, Mahi, Luni basin) and the Indira Gandhi Canal.
- **Low industrialisation** — secondary sector share is small; industry clusters in a few pockets (Jaipur, Bhilwara, Kota, Alwar–Bhiwadi, Pali).

- **Low per-capita income and social indicators** — literacy and health indicators have historically trailed national averages (details in Chapter 7).
- **Desert and dispersed settlements** — delivering roads, schools, hospitals and power across a huge, thinly settled area costs more per person.
- **Rain-fed agriculture** — a large share of the cropped area has no irrigation, so farm income swings with the monsoon.

MEMORY HOOK: Every "issue of Rajasthan's economy" answer in RAS is a chain: **less water → rain-fed farming → low farm income → pressure for government jobs and welfare schemes.** Remember the chain and most statement questions solve themselves.

1.6 Reading the state's numbers the RAS way

- The Economic Review reports sector shares for **GSVA (Gross State Value Added)** — GSDP measured from the production side, before taxes on products are added. Prelims questions use "share in GSVA" language, so treat GSVA share and GSDP share as the same story at this level.
- The stable pattern to remember: **agriculture and allied activities contribute roughly a quarter or more of value added, industry a little over a quarter, and services close to half** — while employment runs in almost the reverse order, with agriculture carrying about half the workers.
- That mismatch has a name examiners like: **low labour productivity in agriculture** — too many workers sharing too little farm income. It is the analytical root of most "issues" statements.
- Per-capita income comparisons always put Rajasthan **below the Indian average**; the state is classified among the lower-income major states, which is also why it receives a relatively large Finance Commission share under the "income distance" criterion (Chapter 2).

MEMORY HOOK: Shares in the economy chapters are asked as a **ranking**, never as exact decimals: services first in income, agriculture first in jobs, industry last in both. Rankings survive revisions; decimals do not.

1.7 The Rajasthan Economic Review

- The **Economic Review** is the state government's official annual report on Rajasthan's economy, presented in the State Legislature **along with the State Budget** every year.
- It is prepared by the **Directorate of Economics and Statistics** under the Planning Department.
- It contains the official figures for GSDP, sector performance, agriculture, industry, infrastructure and social sectors — the source from which RAS setters lift state facts.

PYQ PATTERN: "Economic Review of Rajasthan is published by / presented with — ?" Answer: the Directorate of Economics and Statistics; presented in the Vidhan Sabha with the annual budget.

Chapter 2 — The State Budget and State Finances

2.1 How a state budget works

- A state budget mirrors the Union budget in structure. Article **202** of the Constitution requires the Governor to cause the **Annual Financial Statement** to be laid before the State Legislature each year.

- The budget has the same three funds: **Consolidated Fund of the State** (all revenues and loans; spending needs the Assembly's approval), **Contingency Fund** (for urgent unforeseen spending), and **Public Account** (provident funds, deposits — money the state holds in trust).
- Money Bills and demands for grants are voted only by the **Legislative Assembly**; Rajasthan is unicameral, so there is no Legislative Council stage — a point RAS likes to combine with polity.

EXAM TRAP: At the Centre, the Railway Budget merged with the general budget in 2017 — Rajasthan never had a separate railway budget to merge. Do not carry Union-budget trivia blindly into state questions.

2.2 Where the state's money comes from

Own tax revenue — the state's own taxes

Tax	Base	Note
SGST	State's share of GST on goods and services	The single largest own-tax source after GST
State Excise	Liquor	Alcohol is kept out of GST, so excise on liquor stays fully with the state
Stamps and Registration	Property and document transactions	Rises with real-estate activity
VAT / Sales Tax	Petroleum products and liquor	Petrol, diesel and alcohol are outside GST, so VAT on them is a major state earner
Vehicle Tax	Motor vehicles	Collected under the state motor vehicles taxation law
Electricity Duty, Land Revenue, Entertainment and others	Smaller heads	Land revenue is now a minor source, though historically the biggest

MEMORY HOOK: **GST took the big taxes in, but liquor and petrol stayed out** — that is why state excise and VAT on petroleum/alcohol are always among the top own-revenue heads of Rajasthan.

Non-tax revenue

- **Mining royalty** — Rajasthan's mineral wealth makes royalty on minerals a major non-tax source; mining receipts are a signature Rajasthan revenue line.
- Interest receipts, dividends from state PSUs, fees for services (irrigation, water supply, police, education), and forest receipts make up the rest.

Transfers from the Centre

- **Share in central taxes** — the Finance Commission (Article 280) decides what share of the divisible pool of central taxes goes to all states together (vertical share) and how it is divided among states (horizontal share). Population, area, forest cover, income distance and demographic performance are the typical criteria.
- **Grants-in-aid** — revenue-deficit grants, sector grants and local-body grants recommended by the Finance Commission, plus scheme transfers under Centrally Sponsored Schemes (shared cost between Centre and state).

2.3 Where the money goes — the committed expenditure problem

- A large part of Rajasthan's revenue is pre-committed before any new scheme is announced:

- **Salaries** of government employees - **Pensions** of retired employees - **Interest payments** on past borrowings

- Together these are called **committed expenditure**. When committed expenditure eats most of revenue receipts, little is left for development — a standard "issue in state finances" statement in RAS.

PYQ PATTERN: Statement-type questions recur: "A major portion of Rajasthan's revenue expenditure goes to salaries, pensions and interest payments." — **True**, and it is the textbook definition of the committed-expenditure problem.

- **Revenue deficit** = revenue expenditure minus revenue receipts (borrowing to run daily expenses — bad). **Fiscal deficit** = total expenditure minus total non-debt receipts (the year's total borrowing need).

2.4 FRBM and state debt

- Rajasthan was among the early states to enact a **Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) Act** (2005), committing the state to cap its fiscal deficit at about **3% of GSDP** and eliminate revenue deficit.
- The Fifteenth Finance Commission allowed states a fiscal deficit path around 3% of GSDP in normal years, with small extra room linked to power-sector reforms.
- State borrowings come mainly as **market loans** (State Development Loans auctioned by the RBI), plus loans from the Centre and financial institutions.

2.5 Revenue and capital sides of the budget

- **Revenue receipts** — taxes, non-tax revenue and central transfers that do not create a liability. **Revenue expenditure** — salaries, pensions, interest, subsidies and scheme running costs that create no asset.
- **Capital receipts** — borrowings and loan recoveries. **Capital expenditure** — roads, canals, buildings and other assets, plus loans given by the state.
- The health test RAS applies: a good budget borrows for **capital** spending (assets that serve for decades), while borrowing for **revenue** spending (daily costs) creates a revenue deficit and is the state's chronic weakness.
- **Subsidies and free services** — free electricity to farmers, free medicines, subsidised meals — are revenue expenditure, which is why welfare expansion and the revenue deficit are discussed together in the Economic Review.

PYQ PATTERN: Pair to fix in memory — "revenue deficit = borrowing to meet day-to-day expenses." Any option that ties revenue deficit to asset creation is the planted error; asset creation belongs to the capital account.

2.6 The State Finance Commission

- **Article 243I** of the Constitution requires the Governor to constitute a **State Finance Commission (SFC)** every five years.
- Its job: recommend how the state's taxes and grants should be shared with **Panchayati Raj Institutions and Municipalities**, and how to improve local bodies' finances.
- Do not confuse it with the **Union Finance Commission (Article 280)**, which divides money between the Centre and states. The SFC divides money between the **state and its local bodies**.

Commission	Article	Divides money between	Appointed by
Union Finance Commission	280	Centre ↔ States	President
State Finance Commission	243I	State ↔ Panchayats & Municipalities	Governor

EXAM TRAP: A favourite RAS pair — "State Finance Commission – Article 243I" is correct; pairing it with 280 is the planted error.

MEMORY HOOK: 280 does the big national split; 243I does the local split. Two numbers, two levels — RAS tests them together deliberately.

Chapter 3 — Agriculture and Allied Sector

3.1 Farming in a dry state — the big picture

- About **half of Rajasthan's workforce** depends on agriculture and allied activities, making this sector the state's largest employer even though services earn more income.
- Most farming is **rain-fed**; the monsoon is short and uncertain, and rainfall drops sharply from the south-east to the west.
- The farming year still follows **Kharif** (sown with the monsoon — bajra, guar, pulses, cotton, groundnut), **Rabi** (winter — mustard, wheat, gram, barley) and a small **Zaid** (summer) season where irrigation exists.

3.2 The cropping pattern

Season	Main crops	Where / why
Kharif	**Bajra** (pearl millet), guar, moong and other pulses, cotton, groundnut, maize, sesame	Bajra dominates the dry west — it survives on the least rain; maize is stronger in the southern tribal belt
Rabi	**Mustard**, wheat, gram, barley, cumin and other seed spices in pockets	Mustard is the signature rabi crop of the eastern plains (Bharatpur–Alwar belt)

- **Bajra** is the largest foodgrain crop of the state by area and Rajasthan is India's **largest bajra producer**.
- **Mustard**: Rajasthan is India's **largest mustard producer** — roughly two-fifths or more of the country's output in typical years. Bharatpur is famously linked with mustard and even hosts the national mustard research centre.
- **Guar (cluster bean)**: Rajasthan is India's **largest guar producer**; guar gum from the dry western districts (Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner side) is an export-linked industrial input.
- **Cotton** is grown mainly in the canal-irrigated north (Ganganagar–Hanumangarh) and parts of the south.
- Seed spices — cumin, coriander, fenugreek — are important cash earners in the arid and semi-arid belts.

EXAM TRAP: Wheat is important in the irrigated north and east, but it is NOT Rajasthan's signature "largest in India" crop. The signature top-producer crops are **bajra, mustard and guar**. Statement questions that substitute wheat here are testing exactly this.

3.3 Rajasthan's "largest producer" table — learn it cold

Product	Rajasthan's position (standard, widely published)
Bajra	**Largest producer in India**
Mustard (rapeseed-mustard)	**Largest producer in India**
Guar	**Largest producer in India**
Wool	**Largest / leading producer in India**
Milk	Among India's **top producers** (consistently at or near the top; Uttar Pradesh is the other giant)
Total pulses, oilseeds	Among the leading states
Livestock population	Among the largest in India

PYQ PATTERN: "Rajasthan ranks first in India in the production of — ?" Rotate bajra, mustard, guar and wool through your revision; one of these four is the answer in most cycles.

3.4 Livestock — the second backbone

- Rajasthan carries one of India's largest livestock populations (cattle, buffalo, sheep, goats and camels). The **Livestock Census** (conducted every five years by the central government; the 20th census was in 2019) counted roughly **5.7 crore** animals in the state — among the highest state totals.
- Famous indigenous breeds that RAS pairs with districts:

- Cattle — **Tharparkar, Rathi, Gir, Kankrej, Nagori** - Buffalo — **Murrah, Surti** - Sheep — **Marwari, Chokla, Magra, Nali** - Goat — **Marwari, Sirohi, Jakhrana** - Camel — **Bikaneri, Jaisalmeri, Nachna**

- The **camel** is the state animal (in the livestock category); the state has seen special attention to camel conservation as numbers fell.
- Milk: Rajasthan is a dairy giant built on cooperatives — the state federation markets under the **Saras** brand (RCDF — Rajasthan Cooperative Dairy Federation).
- Wool: the state leads India in wool production, built on its large sheep population across the arid districts.

MEMORY HOOK: In a drought, crops die but herds walk. **Livestock is Rajasthan's drought insurance** — that one line explains the sector's weight in the economy and in the paper.

3.5 Irrigation — who actually waters the fields

- The largest source of irrigation in Rajasthan is **wells and tubewells** (groundwater), followed by canals; tanks are minor. This order — wells first, canals second — is a repeat RAS fact.
- **Indira Gandhi Canal (IGNP)**: lifts water from the Harike barrage (Sutlej–Beas waters) into the Thar — Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Bikaner, Jaisalmer and beyond. It turned the northern desert into the state's granary belt for wheat, cotton and mustard, and supplies drinking water to western towns.
- **Chambal Valley Project** (joint with Madhya Pradesh): Gandhi Sagar, Rana Pratap Sagar, Jawahar Sagar dams and the Kota Barrage — irrigation for the Kota–Bundi–Baran (Hadoti) region plus hydropower.

- **Mahi Bajaj Sagar** (with Gujarat) serves the southern tribal belt; the **Bisalpur** dam on the Banas mainly supplies drinking water to Jaipur and other towns.

Source of irrigation	Rank in Rajasthan
Wells & tubewells	1st (largest)
Canals	2nd
Tanks & others	Minor

EXAM TRAP: Because the Indira Gandhi Canal is famous, papers plant "canals are the largest source of irrigation in Rajasthan." False — **groundwater (wells and tubewells) irrigates more area** than all canals combined.

3.6 The groundwater crisis — dark zones

- Years of tubewell pumping have pushed many blocks into **over-exploited ("dark zone")** category in the official groundwater assessment — areas where extraction exceeds recharge.
- The state's stage of groundwater development is among India's highest, i.e., Rajasthan pumps a larger share of its rechargeable water than almost any other state.
- Responses taught in the syllabus: watershed development, rainwater harvesting, drip and sprinkler promotion, and crop choice moving away from water-guzzling crops in dry blocks.

3.7 Government initiatives in agriculture

- **Mukhyamantri Jal Swavlamban Abhiyan (MJSA)** — the state's flagship water-harvesting and watershed campaign (launched 2016): village-level construction and repair of water structures, run as a mass movement with public participation.
- **Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana** ("per drop more crop") operates in the state for micro-irrigation — drip and sprinklers suit Rajasthan's scarcity.
- The **Rajasthan Agricultural Competitiveness Project** (World Bank-supported) pushed the idea of farming as a business — farmer groups, value chains and water-efficient production in selected clusters.
- Agricultural universities anchor research: **Swami Keshwanand Rajasthan Agricultural University, Bikaner**, **Maharana Pratap University of Agriculture and Technology, Udaipur**, and **Sri Karan Narendra Agriculture University, Jobner** — names RAS matches with cities.

3.8 Marketing, cooperatives and the dry-land niches

- Farm produce moves through regulated **Krishi Upaj Mandis** under the state agricultural marketing framework; the cooperative structure (RAJFED for marketing, the cooperative banks for credit) is the institutional backbone RAS expects you to recognise by name.
- **Horticulture niches** that appear in pair questions: **kinnow** in the Ganganagar belt, **pomegranate** in the west, **mehndi (henna)** of Sojat (Pali), **isabgol** in the Jalore–Barmer side, and **olive cultivation** promoted in the arid districts as a high-value experiment (with a refinery set up at Bikaner) — olive is asked precisely because it sounds foreign to Rajasthan.
- **Agro-climatic zones**: the state is divided into 10 agro-climatic zones for research and extension — a number worth fixing, as zone-count questions rotate with the university names.

PYQ PATTERN: Match-the-pair favourites from this chapter — "Tharparkar – cattle breed", "Saras – milk brand", "IGNP – Harike", "MJSA – water harvesting". Revise them as pairs, not as paragraphs.

Chapter 4 — Industry and Services

4.1 The industrial profile — stone, cloth and craft

Rajasthan's industry grew out of what the land provides: **stone, limestone, fibres and skilled hands**. The secondary sector is smaller than in India's industrial states, but its pockets are famous.

Industry	Centre / fact	Why RAS asks it
Cement	Among India's largest cement-producing states; plants cluster on limestone belts — Chittorgarh, Kota, Nimbahera side	"Limestone → cement" is the classic resource-industry pair
Textiles	**Bhilwara — the "Textile City"** (also called the Manchester of Rajasthan), a national hub for suiting fabric	One of the most repeated one-liners in the paper
Gems & jewellery	**Jaipur** — world-famous for coloured gemstones, cutting and polishing, and jewellery exports	Jaipur = gems is a permanent pair
Marble & stone	**Makrana** marble (the Taj Mahal's marble came from Makrana); **Kishangarh** is a giant marble mandi/processing hub	"Makrana – marble" appears in almost every cycle
Handicrafts	Blue pottery and meenakari (Jaipur), bandhej tie-dye, block printing (Sanganer, Bagru), mojari footwear, camel-leather and wooden craft	Asked as district–craft matching
Salt	**Sambhar** — India's largest inland salt lake and a major salt source	Links geography and industry
Granite	Jalore belt is a major granite processing centre	Frequently matched with the district

MEMORY HOOK: Learn industry as **place → product** pairs only: Bhilwara→cloth, Makrana→marble, Kishangarh→marble mandi, Jaipur→gems, Sambhar→salt, Jalore→granite. Six pairs cover most industrial questions on Rajasthan.

4.2 Institutions and policy

- **RIICO (Rajasthan State Industrial Development and Investment Corporation)** — the state agency that develops industrial areas, provides land and infrastructure and promotes investment. Its industrial areas (Sitapura in Jaipur, Bhiwadi in Alwar region, Boranada in Jodhpur and many more) are where factories actually sit.
- **RFC (Rajasthan Financial Corporation)** — the state financial corporation that lends to small and medium industries.
- **RIPS — Rajasthan Investment Promotion Scheme** — the state's flagship incentive package (exemptions and subsidies on taxes, stamp duty, electricity duty etc.) to attract investment; versions are renewed every few years (RIPS 2019, then RIPS 2022).
- Industrial summits under names like **Rising Rajasthan** and **Resurgent Rajasthan** are the state's investor-outreach platforms — know the concept, not the year-wise branding.

- Special zones: **Mahindra World City (Jaipur)** is a well-known multi-product SEZ; Sitapura (Jaipur) hosts gems, jewellery and IT units.

4.3 MSMEs — the quiet majority

- Most of Rajasthan's industrial employment is in **micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs)** — looms, stone units, craft workshops, food processing and small engineering.
- Small units dominate because the state's craft and textile traditions are workshop-based; government policy (RIPS benefits, MSME facilitation and a separate MSME policy thrust) treats them as the employment engine.
- The **Udyam/Udyog Aadhaar** registration system and One District One Product (ODOP) idea — each district promotes its signature product — connect directly to the district–product pairs in the table above.

PYQ PATTERN: "One District One Product" questions ask the district's signature craft/product — revise it together with the Chapter 4 table, not separately.

4.4 Tourism — the services flagship

- Tourism is a **declared industry** of the state and one of the largest services earners; Rajasthan is consistently among India's top states for both domestic and foreign tourist visits.
- The product is heritage: **Amber, Hawa Mahal and Jantar Mantar (Jaipur)**, the lake city **Udaipur**, golden **Jaisalmer**, blue **Jodhpur**, **Bikaner**, the hill station **Mount Abu**, **Ranthambore and Sariska** (wildlife/tiger tourism), and **Pushkar** (fair and pilgrimage).
- UNESCO World Heritage listings strengthen the brand: Jantar Mantar (Jaipur), the **Hill Forts of Rajasthan** (six forts including Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore, Amber, Jaisalmer, Gagron), and Jaipur's **Walled City**.
- **Heritage hotels** — palaces and havelis converted into hotels — are a Rajasthan speciality and a favourite factual line in the paper.
- The luxury tourist train **Palace on Wheels** is a signature Rajasthan tourism product.
- Fairs and festivals — Pushkar Fair, Desert Festival (Jaisalmer), Elephant Festival tradition in Jaipur, Marwar and Mewar festivals — are treated as tourism products in the syllabus.

MEMORY HOOK: RAS treats tourism three ways at once — an **industry** (declared status), a **service** (income share), and a **heritage list** (UNESCO sites). A statement can be true in one framing and tested in another; read the wording.

4.5 IT and modern services

- **Bhamashah Techno Hub, Jaipur** — the state's flagship startup and IT hub, among the largest incubation facilities promoted by a state government, anchoring Rajasthan's startup ecosystem (iStart Rajasthan is the state startup platform).
- Jaipur also hosts growing IT/ITES units in the Sitapura and Mahindra World City areas.
- Services growth in the state is led by **trade, hotels and restaurants, transport, real estate, banking and public administration** — the Economic Review lists these as the fast growers, a standard statement-question source.

4.6 Why services lead the economy

- Tourism, trade and transport need customers, not rainfall — so services grow even in drought years that hurt farming.
- A big government sector (administration, education, health) adds steady services income.
- The services lead explains the budget story too: a state whose income is service-led but whose jobs are farm-based must spend heavily on rural support — connect this chapter back to Chapter 1's central problem.

EXAM TRAP: "Tourism is the largest contributor to Rajasthan's GSDP" is an exaggeration planted in statements — tourism is a major services component and a declared industry, but the services sector as a whole, not tourism alone, is the largest income contributor.

Chapter 5 — Infrastructure: Energy, Transport and Communication

5.1 Energy — the sun becomes the asset

- Rajasthan has the **highest solar potential in India** (official assessments place it at the top, helped by the Thar's clear skies and vast open land).
- **Bhadla Solar Park** (Jodhpur district, Phalodi side) is among the **largest solar parks in the world**, with capacity counted in thousands of megawatts built in phases.
- Other large solar locations cluster in the western districts — Jaisalmer, Bikaner, Jodhpur, Barmer — close to the sun and to empty land.
- Solar policy: the state has run dedicated solar policies (2019 policy onwards) promoting solar parks, rooftop solar and solar pumps (with the national PM-KUSUM scheme for farmers).

PYQ PATTERN: "Bhadla" is asked in three flavours — where (Jodhpur/Phalodi area), what (solar park), and rank (among the world's largest). Prepare all three.

5.2 Wind and conventional power

- **Wind energy** is concentrated at **Jaisalmer**, the state's wind hub; the western ridge districts (Barmer, Jodhpur, Pratapgarh in the south) also host turbines. Rajasthan stands among India's leading wind states, though Tamil Nadu and Gujarat lead nationally.
- Major **thermal (coal/lignite) stations**:

- **Suratgarh** (Ganganagar) — among the state's biggest thermal stations - **Kota Super Thermal** — on the Chambal at Kota - **Chhabra** (Baran) - **Kalisindh** (Jhalawar) - Lignite-based stations near **Barmer (Kapoordi–Jalipa side)** and **Neyveli-linked Barsingsar (Bikaner)**

- **Hydel share** comes mainly from Rajasthan's share in the **Chambal projects** (Rana Pratap Sagar, Jawahar Sagar) and the **Mahi** project — hydropower is a minor share of the state's total capacity.
- **Rawatbhata (RAPP)** near Kota hosts nuclear power units — Rajasthan's atomic power station is a fixed GK pair: **Rawatbhata – nuclear**.
- Distribution is handled by the state's three DISCOMs (Jaipur, Ajmer and Jodhpur Vidyut Vitran Nigam) after the unbundling of the old state electricity board.

Source	Rajasthan's signature fact
Solar	Highest potential in India; Bhadla among the world's largest parks
Wind	Jaisalmer is the wind hub
Thermal	Suratgarh, Kota, Chhabra are the big names
Hydel	Share from Chambal and Mahi projects; small share overall
Nuclear	Rawatbhata (near Kota)

EXAM TRAP: Swap-trap — "Kota" belongs to both thermal (Kota Super Thermal) and nuclear (Rawatbhata is in Chittorgarh district near Kota city region). Read carefully: the question's wording "atomic/nuclear" points to Rawatbhata; "thermal" points to the coal stations.

5.3 Transport — roads across a desert

- Rajasthan's **road density is below the national average** — a standard fact explained by the huge area and sparse desert population.
- The road network mixes National Highways, State Highways, district and village roads; the state PWD and the Rajasthan State Road Development Corporation handle state roads, and **RSRTC** is the state road transport corporation running buses.
- **Jaipur Metro** — the state's only metro rail, operational in Jaipur (first phase opened 2015); a second phase is under development. "Only metro city of Rajasthan = Jaipur" is a safe fact.
- **Delhi–Mumbai Expressway** passes through Rajasthan (Dausa–Kota side), sharply cutting Delhi–Mumbai travel time; the **Amritsar–Jamnagar Economic Corridor** crosses the state's north-west (Ganganagar–Hanumangarh–Bikaner side), linking Punjab ports-side trade to the desert districts.
- **DMIC — Delhi–Mumbai Industrial Corridor**: the dedicated freight corridor and its influence zone cover a large part of Rajasthan; planned nodes in the state include the **Khushkhera–Bhiwadi–Neemrana** region and the **Jodhpur–Pali–Marwar** region — the state's big industrial-future fact.

MEMORY HOOK: Corridor questions are place questions in disguise — Expressway = Dausa–Kota direction; Amritsar–Jamnagar = north-west districts; DMIC nodes = Bhiwadi–Neemrana and Jodhpur–Pali–Marwar.

5.4 Railways and air links in brief

- Rajasthan is served mainly by the **North Western Railway**, headquartered at **Jaipur** — a zone-headquarter pair the paper asks directly.
- Air connectivity centres on **Jaipur International Airport**, with domestic airports at **Udaipur, Jodhpur, Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Kishangarh and Kota**; the UDAN regional-connectivity scheme revived several smaller airstrips.
- Road, rail and air together explain the tourism map of Chapter 4: the Jaipur–Udaipur–Jodhpur triangle is both the best-connected and the most-visited circuit.

5.5 Communication and digital delivery

- **e-Mitra** is Rajasthan's signature digital service-delivery network — thousands of kiosks (and now mobile/online modes) delivering government certificates, bill payments, banking and scheme

applications at the village and ward level. RAS treats e-Mitra as the face of e-governance in the state.

- The **Jan Aadhaar** card (successor idea to Bhamashah) is the family-ID backbone through which many state scheme benefits and DBT payments are routed.
- Rajasthan's own fibre network (RajSWAN / BharatNet phases) connects government offices down to blocks and panchayats.

PYQ PATTERN: e-Mitra is asked as "which platform delivers citizen services through kiosks in Rajasthan" — and Jan Aadhaar as "family-based ID for scheme benefits". Both are one-line facts; do not bury them.

Chapter 6 — Rural Development, Panchayati Raj and Local Finance

6.1 Why rural Rajasthan matters most

- A large majority of Rajasthan's people still live in villages, so rural development is not a side topic — it is where most of the economy's workers and most welfare spending sit.
- The rural economy rests on rain-fed farming and livestock (Chapter 3), plus wage employment schemes and remittances.

6.2 MGNREGA in Rajasthan

- The **Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act** gives up to **100 days** of unskilled wage employment per rural household per year on demand.
- Rajasthan is consistently one of the **largest implementing states** (very high person-days generated), thanks to its large rural workforce and dry-season demand for work.
- Works focus on water conservation, drought proofing and rural assets — in Rajasthan, MGNREGA and water structures go together (check dams, ponds, pasture development).
- The state has from time to time announced additional days from its own resources in drought-affected areas — know the concept; year-specific day counts keep changing.

PYQ PATTERN: The fixed legal number is **100 days** — planted options say 125 or 150. State top-ups change; the Act's guarantee does not.

6.3 Rajeevika — the livelihoods mission

- **RGAVP — Rajasthan Grameen Ajeevika Vikas Parishad**, working through the brand **Rajeevika**, is the state's rural livelihoods mission.
- Its method: organise rural poor women into **Self-Help Groups (SHGs)**, federate them, link them to bank credit and build livelihoods (farm, livestock, non-farm enterprise).
- It implements the national rural livelihoods architecture (DAY-NRLM) in Rajasthan.

MEMORY HOOK: Remember the chain — **RGAVP is the body, Rajeevika is the brand, SHGs of women are the method.** Three-part pair questions are built from exactly this chain.

6.4 Panchayati Raj finance — strong duties, weak own revenue

- Rajasthan's Panchayati Raj system (three tiers — Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Zila Parishad) carries development functions, but PRIs' **own revenue is very weak**: panchayats raise little from local taxes and fees and depend on grants.
- Money reaches PRIs mainly through:

- **State Finance Commission awards** (Chapter 2 — Article 243I devolution from the state) - **Union Finance Commission grants** for local bodies (tied and untied grants routed to panchayats) - Scheme funds for MGNREGA, housing, sanitation and water programmes

- This dependence is the standard "problem of PRI finance" statement: **functions are many, functionaries and funds are short.**

EXAM TRAP: The SFC recommends sharing of the **state's** revenues with local bodies. The Union Finance Commission's local-body grants come from the **Centre's** side. Questions that swap the two sources are planted traps.

6.5 Rural housing and sanitation in brief

- **PMAY-Gramin (Pradhan Mantri Awaas Yojana – Gramin)** — pucca houses for rural poor households, cost shared between Centre and state; Rajasthan registers large beneficiary numbers every cycle.
- **Swachh Bharat Mission – Gramin (SBM-G)** — toilet construction and Open Defecation Free (ODF) status for villages; Rajasthan declared its rural areas ODF under the mission's first phase and continues with ODF-plus (solid and liquid waste) work.
- Both are Centrally Sponsored Schemes implemented by the state — the standard template for rural programmes in the paper.

6.6 Watersheds and common lands — the quiet rural programme

- Because rainfall is the binding constraint (Chapter 1), **watershed development** is a permanent rural programme in Rajasthan: treating a drainage area with check dams, contour bunds, pasture development and plantation so that rain stays where it falls.
- The national watershed architecture (earlier DPAP and Integrated Watershed Management, now carried in the PMKSY watershed component) has covered large desert and semi-arid areas of the state.
- **Pasture and common-land development** links back to livestock: village gochars and orans (traditional sacred commons) are the grazing base of the herd economy, and protecting them is treated as an economic, not only environmental, programme.

MEMORY HOOK: Rural Rajasthan's programmes form one sentence — **MGNREGA gives wages, watersheds keep the rain, Rajeevika organises the women, and the Finance Commissions fund the panchayats that run them.**

Chapter 7 — Basic Social Services: Education and Health

7.1 Education — where the state stands

- **Literacy (Census 2011): Rajasthan's literacy rate was 66.1%** — below the national average, with a wide male–female gap (male literacy around 79%, female literacy around 52%).

The female literacy figure, among India's lowest in 2011, is the single most-asked education statistic of the state.

PYQ PATTERN: "Literacy rate of Rajasthan as per Census 2011 — 66.1%." Options around it (67.1, 66.6, 65.1) are digit-traps; fix **66.1** in memory, and female ≈ 52% with it.

- School education runs through **Samagra Shiksha** (the integrated school programme that absorbed SSA), implementing the **Right to Education Act** guarantee of free and compulsory education for ages 6–14.
- The state's school network is huge and dispersed — the desert problem of Chapter 1 returns here: small habitations, long distances, teacher shortage in remote postings.

7.2 Education initiatives of the state

- **Mahatma Gandhi Government Schools (English Medium)** — the state converted and opened government schools teaching in English medium, so poor families could access English-medium schooling without private fees. Know the concept and the naming; school counts change yearly.
- **Gargi Puraskar** — a well-known state award encouraging girls' education: a cash award to meritorious girl students of government schools at the secondary stage (it is also a favourite Current Affairs item when amounts are revised — the scheme's PURPOSE is the permanent fact).
- **Free cycles, scooties and laptops/tablets** for meritorious students, and free textbooks/uniforms in government schools, are recurring state education-support measures.
- Universities in brief (RAS matches names with cities):

- **University of Rajasthan, Jaipur** and **Mohanlal Sukhadia University, Udaipur** - **Jai Narain Vyas University, Jodhpur** and **Maharshi Dayanand Saraswati University, Ajmer** - Agricultural universities at **Bikaner, Udaipur and Jobner** (Chapter 3) - National-level institutions — **MNIT Jaipur, IIT Jodhpur, AIIMS Jodhpur** — anchor the higher-education map.

7.3 Health — the assurance model

Rajasthan built its health story on **free and assured care** rather than only on hospitals:

Scheme / institution	What it is	The one-line fact
Mukhyamantri Nishulk Dava Yojana	Free medicines in government hospitals	**Launched 2011** — one of the most-asked scheme-year pairs in the paper
Mukhyamantri Nishulk Janch Yojana	Free diagnostic tests in government facilities	The "free tests" companion of the free-medicine scheme
Chiranjeevi → MAA Yojana	The state's health assurance (insurance) scheme	Launched as **Chiranjeevi Swasthya Bima Yojana**; continued and renamed as **Mukhyamantri Ayushman Arogya (MAA) Yojana**, giving cashless treatment cover per family in empanelled hospitals
RGHS — Rajasthan Government Health Scheme	Cashless health cover for state government employees, pensioners and their families	RGHS = employees/pensioners; MAA = general public — do not swap them
Janani Suraksha Yojana (JSY)	Central scheme promoting institutional delivery with cash assistance to mothers	Implemented statewide; Rajasthan also runs related maternal support measures

Scheme / institution	What it is	The one-line fact
Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation (RMSCL)	Centralised body procuring drugs and equipment for the free schemes	The machinery behind Nishulk Dava — a known factual line

MEMORY HOOK: Health in Rajasthan = **free medicine (2011) + free tests + assured cashless cover (Chiranjeevi → MAA) + RGHS for employees.** Four blocks, and every health-scheme question fits one of them.

EXAM TRAP: Chiranjeevi and MAA are not two rival schemes — MAA is the continued, renamed form of the Chiranjeevi health assurance. A statement treating them as simultaneous separate schemes is false.

- Ayushman Bharat (PM-JAY) operates nationally; in Rajasthan its beneficiary framework has been run in integration with the state's own assurance scheme — the paper's angle is the state scheme's name and lineage above.

Chapter 8 — Major Welfare Schemes of Rajasthan

RAS asks this chapter as pure scheme-matching: **name → purpose → beneficiary**. Learn the table line by line; the notes after it only add the traps.

Scheme	Purpose	Beneficiary
Annapurna Rasoi Yojana (earlier run as Indira Rasoi)	Subsidised cooked meals (thali) through community kitchens	Urban poor, workers, travellers — anyone needing a cheap meal
Palanhar Yojana	Monthly assistance for the care and upbringing of orphaned children by their caretaker (palanhar)	Orphan children and their caregivers
Mukhyamantri Kanyadan Yojana	Financial assistance at the marriage of daughters	Poor families (BPL and specified categories)
Social Security Pension schemes	Monthly pensions under one umbrella — old age (Mukhyamantri Vridhjan Samman Pension), widow (Mukhyamantri Ekal Nari Samman Pension) and divyangjan pensions	Elderly, widows/single women, persons with disabilities from poor households
Indira Gandhi Matritva Poshan Yojana	Nutrition support to pregnant women, linked to the second child and health check-ups	Pregnant and lactating mothers in covered districts
Mukhyamantri Dugdh Utpadak Sambal Yojana	Bonus (sambal) payment per litre to milk producers supplying cooperative dairies	Dairy farmers of the cooperative network (Saras)
Devnarayan Yojana / schemes	Hostels, scooties and educational support for students of the Gurjar and other Special Backward Classes	SBC community students
Meghwal (Medhwal) student support measures	Hostel and education support in the state's SC-student welfare framework	Scheduled Caste students
Indira Gandhi Smartphone Yojana	Free smartphones to women heads of families (with internet data for a period)	Women heads of Jan Aadhaar families
Mukhyamantri Yuva Sambal Yojana	Monthly unemployment allowance to educated unemployed youth	Unemployed graduates of the state

Scheme	Purpose	Beneficiary
Mukhyamantri Kanyadan / Vivah support	See Kanyadan row — one scheme family, one purpose	Poor families at daughters' marriage
Palanhar + foster care	See Palanhar row — the child's caretaker receives the support, not an institution	Orphaned children

- **Annapurna Rasoi**: the kitchen network began under the name **Indira Rasoi Yojana** and continues as **Annapurna Rasoi** — a renaming line the paper loves. Purpose: a filling, dignified meal at a heavily subsidised price in urban areas.

EXAM TRAP: Palanhar money goes to the **caretaker of the orphan**, not to an orphanage. The scheme's whole idea is family-based care — statements that send the money to institutions are wrong.

- **Old-age, widow and disability pensions** sit under the state's Social Security Pension umbrella; amounts are revised periodically, so RAS asks the **structure** (which pension exists for whom), not the current rupee figure.
- **How RAS frames this chapter**: almost every question is either (1) match the scheme to its beneficiary, (2) pick the scheme from a one-line description of its work, or (3) spot the wrong pair in a list. A wrong pair is usually made by swapping two similar-sounding entries — Kanyadan with Palanhar, or the milk bonus with a crop bonus. When two options look close, ask "who receives the money?" — beneficiary, not ministry, separates them.
- **Indira Priyadarshini**-linked training and skill programmes for women have run in the state's women-empowerment framework — know the thrust (training and employment support for women) rather than any single year's batch details.
- Two scheme families dominate this chapter in the paper: **food and marriage** for household welfare (Annapurna Rasoi, Kanyadan), and **life-stage support** (Palanhar for the orphaned child, pensions for the old, Matritva Poshan for the new mother). Place each scheme in its family and matching questions become easy.

PYQ PATTERN: The single most-tested welfare lines of recent cycles: "Palanhar – orphan care", "Annapurna Rasoi (Indira Rasoi) – subsidised meals", "Nishulk Dava – 2011", "Kanyadan – daughters' marriage assistance", "Dugdh Utpadak Sambal – milk producers' bonus". Five lines; revise them weekly.

MEMORY HOOK: Welfare schemes are verbs, not names — Palanhar **raises**, Rasoi **feeds**, Kanyadan **marries**, Sambal **supports**, Pension **secures**. Match the verb and the scheme follows.

Chapter 9 — Master Revision Grids

9.1 Firsts and largest of the Rajasthan economy

Fact	Answer
India's largest state by area	Rajasthan
Largest sector by income (GSDP share)	Services (tertiary)
Largest sector by employment	Agriculture & allied
Crops where Rajasthan is India's largest producer	**Bajra, Mustard, Guar**
India's leading wool producer	Rajasthan

Fact	Answer
Milk	Rajasthan among India's top producers
Largest source of irrigation	Wells & tubewells
India's largest inland salt source	Sambhar Lake
Highest solar potential in India	Rajasthan
Among the world's largest solar parks	**Bhadla** (Jodhpur district)
State's only metro city	Jaipur
Textile City of Rajasthan	Bhilwara
Famous marble source (Taj Mahal marble)	Makrana
State milk brand / federation	Saras / RCDF
State industrial development corporation	RIICO
Health assurance scheme (current form)	Mukhyamantri Ayushman Arogya (MAA), earlier Chiranjeevi
Free medicine scheme launch year	**2011** (Nishulk Dava Yojana)
Literacy rate, Census 2011	**66.1%**

9.2 "Which district?" quick grid

Asked for	District / place
Bhadla Solar Park	Jodhpur (Phalodi side)
Wind energy hub	Jaisalmer
Nuclear power station	Rawatbhata (near Kota)
Big thermal stations	Suratgarh (Ganganagar), Kota, Chhabra (Baran)
Textile city	Bhilwara
Marble quarrying	Makrana (Nagaur)
Marble mandi / processing	Kishangarh (Ajmer)
Gems and jewellery	Jaipur
Salt lake	Sambhar (Jaipur–Nagaur side)
Granite processing	Jalore
Cotton and canal farming (north)	Ganganagar–Hanumangarh
Mustard heartland	Bharatpur–Alwar belt
Bhamashah Techno Hub	Jaipur
DMIC node (north)	Khushkhera–Bhiwadi–Neemrana (Alwar region)
DMIC node (west)	Jodhpur–Pali–Marwar

9.3 The trap list — read the night before

- TRAP: Mustard, not wheat, is Rajasthan's signature top-producer crop; the top-producer trio is **bajra–mustard–guar**.
- TRAP: Agriculture is the largest employer; **services** are the largest income earner. Never swap.
- TRAP: Wells and tubewells irrigate more than canals — the Indira Gandhi Canal's fame is the bait.

- TRAP: State Finance Commission = **Article 243I** (state → local bodies); Union Finance Commission = Article 280 (Centre → states).
- TRAP: RGHS is for **government employees and pensioners**; the public health assurance is **MAA (earlier Chiranjeevi)**.
- TRAP: Palanhar pays the **caretaker**, not an institution.
- TRAP: Indira Rasoi and Annapurna Rasoi are the **same meal scheme, renamed** — not two schemes.
- TRAP: MGNREGA's legal guarantee is **100 days**, whatever the current state top-up.
- TRAP: Census 2011 literacy is **66.1%** — guard against the digit-swapped options.
- TRAP: Liquor and petroleum are **outside GST** — that is why state excise and VAT on them headline the state's own revenues.
- TRAP: "e-Mitra" delivers services; "Jan Aadhaar" identifies the family for benefits. One is the counter, the other is the card.
- TRAP: Tourism is a declared **industry** and part of **services** — but tourism alone is not the largest GSDP contributor; the services sector as a whole is.

MEMORY HOOK: If you can recite the 12 traps above without looking, the Rajasthan economy section of the paper holds no surprises for you.

StuDy